

The Mission Letter from Nanaimo, 2025 December

“See, I am doing a new thing! Now it springs up; do you not perceive it?
I am making a way in the wilderness and streams in the wasteland.” (Isaiah 43:19)

Dear beloved partners in the Lord, we send you warm greetings in Christ. As we stand at the close of 2025, we remember with gratitude the great grace of God that has been poured out upon First nations ministry throughout this year. We humbly confess that through your generous prayers and loving partnership, souls have been restored to life and the work of new life—seeing the Lord—has continued. As we remember the coming of our Lord and look back on this past year, we would like to share with thankful hearts what God has been doing in this land.

1) Toward the Rebuilding of Churches in Northern B. C and Yukon

Last September, by the prayers of our partners, we safely completed a two-week church exploration journey across British Columbia and Yukon, covering a round trip of approximately 8,000 km. It was not an easy journey, with five tire blowouts along the way, but as we visited small towns in each region, we came face to face with the reality of churches in Canada. At the same time, we saw more clearly the grieving heart of God the Father for this land and His vision for the restoration of the church.

The Canadian church that once boldly carried the gospel as far as distant East Asia over 130 years ago—especially Indigenous churches—are now facing closures. Due to declining congregations, a shortage of seminarians, and the absence of pastors, many churches are barely sustained by a few remaining believers before eventually dispersing and closing their doors. Through this exploration journey, we identified a total of seven churches—including Houston Church in northern BC, five churches in the New Hazelton area, and Dawson City Church in Yukon—that we hope to rebuild by sending ten pastoral families. In particular, the purchase of a parsonage for the five churches in the New Hazelton area will be the first step.



Indigenous believers of New Hazelton church



With the exploration team in front of the Arctic Ocean

We see Indigenous mission that began in Nanaimo expanding to northern Vancouver Island, and further to northern British Columbia and Yukon. As we move forward in obedience with a holy vision, we believe we will witness God's work of bringing precious Indigenous souls—worth more than the whole world—back to life. Please pray with us that God would send missionary co-workers and supply all the necessary financial and human resources.



Repeated tire damage during the exploration journey Local believers earnestly praying for the rebuilding of Houston Church

2) News from Nanaimo Native Victory Church

The powerful march of the gospel continues in Nanaimo as well. On October 12, Thanksgiving Sunday, we invited Indigenous community members and those connected through the food bank and shared the grace of gratitude through a Thanksgiving community dinner, along with hair services, nail care, RMT massage, family photo sessions, and various other ministries.

On November 23, we offered Indigenous mission to God and held a special intercessory prayer time. On December 13, we visited each Indigenous village and household, sharing thoughtfully prepared gifts and inviting them to church through a major visitation outreach. On December 21, we held a Christmas Celebration Thanksgiving Service. In particular, the Next Generation United Shadow Play, children's worship dance, youth band special music, autoharp performance, and women's group choir all offered glory to God by giving thanks for the birth of Jesus with the talents He has given.

Last November, the youth ministry was separated from the children's department and officially established as a Youth Department. Every Sunday at 1:00 p.m., 10–20 youth and young adults gather in the main sanctuary to worship together. We praise our faithful God who answered tearful prayers for Indigenous children. Under the passionate and devoted leadership of Pastor Sullivan, youth-centered faith formation is taking place through worship, praise band, large-group and small-group ministries. Please continue to pray that not a single one of our beloved children raised in Nanaimo Native Victory Church would be lost, but that all would grow into a complete and mature faith.



Nanaimo Native Victory Church Next Generation
United Shadow Play Nativity Performance



2025 NNVC Thanksgiving Service



Mission Team Nail Art



NNVC Youth Worship Service



NNVC Youth Small Group



Pastoral Visit to a Sick Member



After NNVC Kid's worship service

3) News from Port Hardy

In Port Hardy, the Indigenous youth who faithfully attend the Thursday youth gathering are gradually becoming settled and rooted. As relationships of deep trust are built with the children by God's grace, we witness worship and fellowship becoming a natural part of their everyday lives, leading us to confess that God is truly at work. We now hope to expand the territory of this ministry and are praying for God to send a prepared co-worker for the next stage.

In addition, during Christmas, we spent a warm time of fellowship with Indigenous youth at a park decorated with Christmas lights, sharing the joyful news of Christ's birth along with lovingly prepared cookies. Through the pure smiles and open hearts of the children, we were given a precious time to once again meditate on the true meaning of Jesus coming into this world.

We are also continuing conversations with the Band Office to begin worship in the Quatsino area. Above all, we urgently need prayer for a place of worship. We earnestly desire that the Lord would open the door for worship and proclaim His presence in that land.

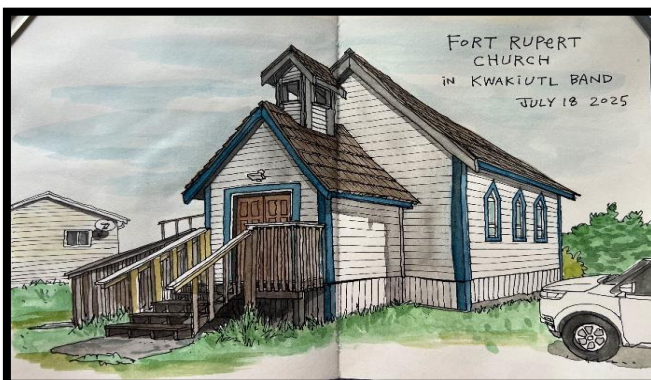
In Port Rupert, we are carrying out door-to-door ministry. With faith and prayer, we meet people one by one and share the gospel with each household. Although patience is required before these efforts are connected to Sunday worship, we believe that those who sow with tears will reap with songs of joy. We praise the Lord who will transform dry land into fertile soil where life springs forth.



Port Hardy youth after Thursday worship



Port Hardy youth Christmas gathering at the park



Watercolor painting of Port Rupert Church



Handmade cookies for the Christmas gathering

4) News from Glad Tidings Church

The church basement that was renovated through the church rebuilding team this past summer is now being used as a precious place of ministry. In addition to Sunday community meals, it has been opened as a venue for neighborhood children's birthday parties, lowering the barriers with the local community. In particular, it has also served as temporary housing for Indigenous neighbors such as the Willian & Rikisha family, becoming a warm place of rest for the community.

In November, thanks to those who completed generator wiring work and installed heaters and heating systems over two nights and three days, the worship space and ministry environment were improved for the winter season. We extend our deep gratitude for the warm hands of partnership that demonstrated the love of the Lord. On Christmas Sunday in December, we invited village families for a celebratory worship service with a turkey meal, and on Christmas Day, we shared Korean food such as bulgogi and kimbap to celebrate the joy of Jesus' birth. It was a truly thankful time to share Korean hospitality and the love of Christ with our neighbors.

Please pray together with us that through the lovingly renovated facilities of Glad Tidings Church, many more souls would return to the Lord; that God would protect the health of the congregation during the cold winter; that Sunday School would experience revival; and that the warmth of the Holy Spirit would fill every ministry field.



Fellowship meal in the renovated basement



After completing Heating and Electrical Work



Carefully prepared Christmas meal and gifts



Children spending time in a warm church

5) The appointment of Rev. Sam Suh and the Launch of the 153 Mission Society

Pastor Sam Suh joined Nanaimo Native Victory Church in November. Having served in Paraguay for four years and as a senior pastor in Chicago for 23 years, Pastor Suh came to Nanaimo with an unceasing passion for the Kingdom of God and a deep burden for Indigenous people in Canada. We praise the Lord who will work anew through his rich missionary and pastoral experience and his shepherd's heart that embraces souls.

Nanaimo Native Victory Church is launching the 153 Mission Society to open a new horizon for specialized Indigenous mission in North America. Beginning with the next newsletter, communications will be sent under the name of the 153 Mission Society. Please pray that wherever the 153 Mission Society serves, there would be a great harvest of souls as we obey the Word and cast the net in faith.

**“He said, ‘Throw your net on the right side of the boat and you will find some.’
When they did, they were unable to haul the net in because of the large number of fish...
So Simon Peter climbed back into the boat and dragged the net ashore.
It was full of large fish, 153, but even with so many the net was not torn.”(John 21:6–11)**



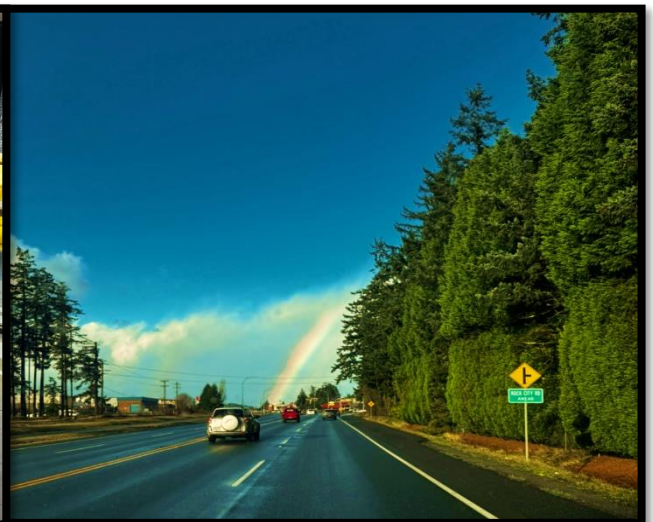
Pastor Sam Suh and Mrs. Christina Suh



153 Mission Society Launch Ceremony and Gathering



With the northern Vancouver Island ministry team



A vivid rainbow shown on the day of
the 153 Mission Society launch

6) Please Pray with Us

1. Lord, Grant a **second Revival** to **Nanaimo Native Victory Church**.
2. Establish churches in **Port Hardy, Quatsala, and Quatsino** villages.
3. Bring revival to all generations at **Glad Tidings Church**.
4. **Rebuild the Lord's churches** in **northern British Columbia** and **Yukon** and **supply all material and human resources**.
5. Raise up the **next generation** of First Nations as a generation of **Faith**.
6. Establish a North American First Nation **Mission Center** for strategic mission.
7. Build the Lord's churches among **the 53 Indigenous tribes** on **Vancouver Island**.

NNVC Pastoral & Missionary Team

- **Rev. Joon Cho** Lead Pastor
- **Rev. Joy Ji** Nanaimo Native Victory Church Director & Next Gen.
- **Rev. Phillip Chung** Nanaimo Native Victory Church Adult & Food Bank
- **Pastor Sullivan Yang** Nanaimo Native Victory Church Youth
- **Rev. Chris Kim** Port Hardy Reginal Director
- **Rev. José Kim** Glad Tidings Church Director
- **Rev. Sarah Kang** Glad Tidings Church Next Gen.
- **Rev. Benjamin Chung** Northern BC & Yukon Regional Director
- **Rev. Sam Suh** Vancouver Island Regional Director
- **Rev. Per & Chris Knudson** Honounary Pastor

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